POTATO AND CRÈME FRAÎCHE FILLING

INGREDIENTS

228 g	Yukon gold potatoes
154 g	Ricotta
225 g	Crème fraîche
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
1/4 lemon	Lemon peel, pith removed and finely chopped
quantity not given	Salt

METHOD

1. Put the potatoes in a pot, cover them with cold water and bring them to a simmer over medium heat. Give them 30 to 45 minutes, until a fork goes through without resistance.
2. Lift them out with a slotted spoon onto a sheet pan and leave them 15 minutes. They dry out a little as they cool.
3. Peel them while they are still warm enough to handle, then pass them through a ricer or food mill into a bowl.
4. Push the riced potato through a tamis or a fine-mesh strainer a second time so it is perfectly smooth.
5. Pulse the ricotta in a food processor to the texture of cake frosting, stopping the moment it turns glossy. Going further breaks it. Scrape it into a bowl.
6. When the potato is completely cold, fold in the ricotta, the crème fraîche, the parmigiano and the lemon peel, just enough to combine. Salt to taste. It wants to taste properly seasoned.
7. Refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.

NOTES

Fold, do not beat. Overworking the potato after the dairy goes in turns it gummy.
The potato is passed twice, through the ricer and then the tamis. That second pass is what makes it smooth enough to pipe.
Whip the ricotta only to a frosting-like sheen. Past that point it breaks and weeps.
The potato has to be completely cold before the crème fraîche meets it.
It is a loose filling, so pasta made with it cooks at a simmer rather than a boil.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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